American, Foreign Affairs' for April, 1944. (The I.L.O. have issued a study on 'The Dis-

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Little seems to **be** known about **the** basic causes behind the falling birth-rate, though many subsidiary ones are suggested. **It** is possible, however, **that** certain physiological and biological reasons lie at the back of it—the kind of life industrialized communities lead and the environment in which they live. A deficient diet, alcoholism, neurotic conditions or poor health generally, mental or physical, affect reproduction. And yet disease-ridden and insufficiently fed communities, as in India, still reproduce ihemselves at a prodigious rate. Perhaps the strain and stress of modern life, the ceaseless competition and worry, lessen fertility. Probably the divorce from the life-giving soil is an important factor. Even in America the fertility of farm labourers is considerably more than double that of the profes-sional classes.

It would seem that the kind of modern civilization that deve-loped first in the west and spread elsewhere, and especially the metropolitan life that has been its chief feature, produces an